

Week one without weights.

Why the plan has no number that didn't come from you.



Every lift I have a number for from the client gets a weight in the plan from week 1. Every other lift doesn't. A number that didn't come from you is a guess, and a guess is either too light or too heavy. So week 1 is the calibration week: you pick, you log, and from week 2 the number is fixed.

01

The rule

No prescribed weight that doesn't come from logged data or from what you told me yourself.

Too light, and the week is wasted. Too heavy, and the reps or the technique get cut short. Either way you can tell after the first set that the number isn't yours.

Then there's the day itself. After a short night, nobody lifts what's written on paper.

02

RPE 7 and RPE 8

The week 1 prescription is a rep range plus an RPE, for example 6 to 8 at RPE 8.

RPE 7: three more reps were there. The set was work, but never in doubt.

RPE 8: two more reps were there. The last one was clearly slower than the first.

03

How to pick the first weight

For set 1, take a weight you can hit the top of the range with for sure.

If that was RPE 6 or easier, add a plate a side for set 2.

Set 3 should end at RPE 8. That's the set you write down.

04

From week 2 the number is fixed

Your heaviest set at RPE 8 from week 1 is the weight for week 2. From then on it's in the plan and no longer picked by feel.

Weeks 3 and 4: same RPE at the same weight means go up, a plate a side. If the RPE goes up, the weight stays.

Calibration week

One line per lift. For every set: weight, reps and the RPE it ended at. The last column is the number that goes into the plan for week 2.

Lift	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Weight for week 2
Squat	90 × 8 @7	100 × 8 @8	100 × 8 @8	100 kg
Main lift 1 _____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg _____
Main lift 2 _____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg _____
Main lift 3 _____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg _____
Lift 4 _____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg _____
Lift 5 _____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg ____ × ____ @ ____	kg _____

THE RULE FROM WEEK 2

e1RM in one line

Load × (1 + reps / 30). 100 kg × 8 is 127, 110 kg × 5 is 128. Same level. That's how you compare sets with different reps.

From week 2 the number is fixed

The weight in the last column goes into the plan for week 2. It is no longer picked by feel.

Weeks 3 and 4

Same RPE at the same weight two weeks running means go up. If the RPE climbs, the weight stays.

YOUR NUMBER

Send me your weight for week 2 as a DM. If you want someone to read your numbers and write the next block: that is what I do.

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